

1804; Clarinet Concerto in F minor, Op. 5, 1815;
Divertimento for Oboe and Strings in C major, Op. 9, 1823;
Frithiofs Saga (songs), 1826

Johann Nepomuk Hummel

1778–1837, AUSTRIAN

A leading figure in the transition from the Classical to the Romantic era in European music, Hummel was born in Pressburg (Bratislava), then part of the Austrian Empire. The son of a prominent musician, he was a child prodigy on piano, embarking on his first international concert tour aged 10. Hummel received lessons from Mozart and Haydn, and as a piano virtuoso in Vienna in the 1790s was a rival of Beethoven. He succeeded Haydn as director of music for Prince Esterházy from 1804 to 1811. Hummel married the singer Elisabeth Röckel in 1813. For the last 18 years of his life he served as director of music at the Weimar court. His own compositions were wide-ranging, including operas, Masses, and chamber music, but he is best known for his piano works, which exerted a major influence on Chopin and Schumann. Hummel was also a prominent conductor, piano teacher, and campaigner for musical copyright.

KEY WORKS: Trumpet Concerto in E major, 1803; Fantasy